

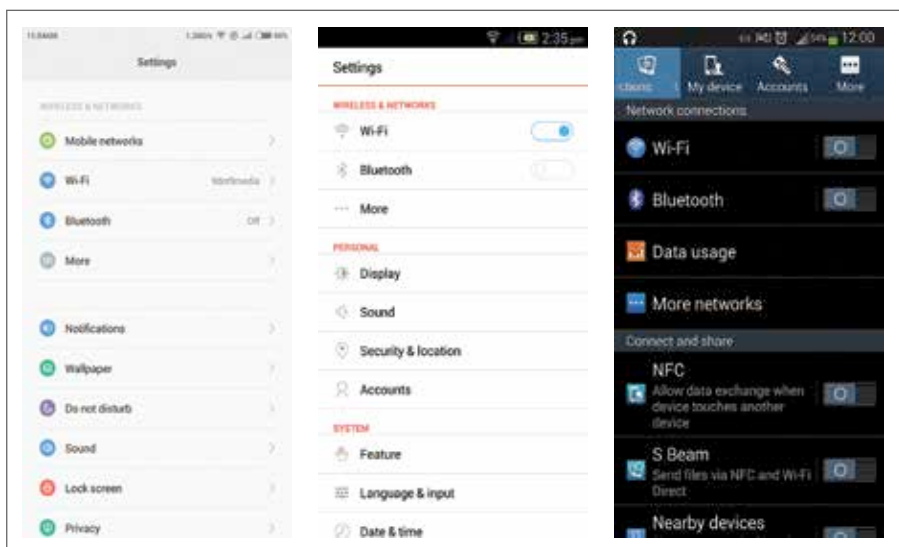
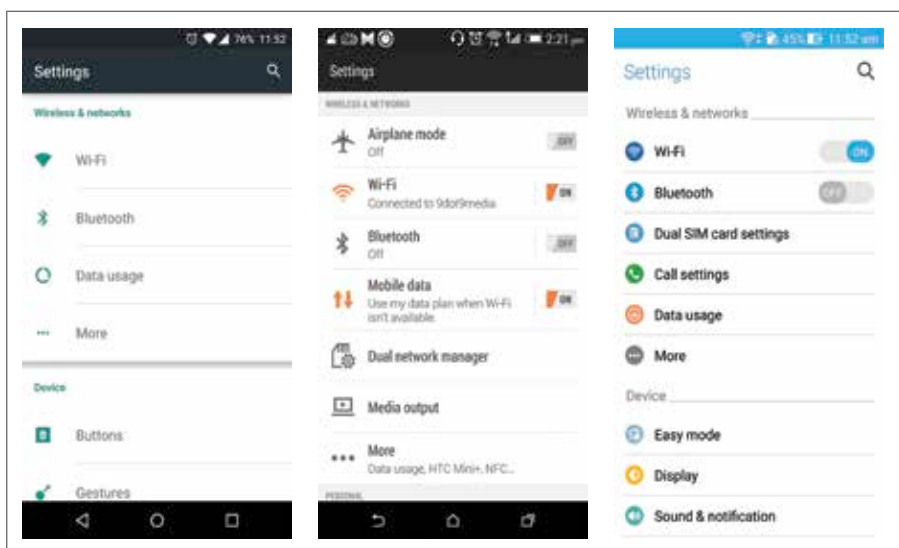


Orcish charms!

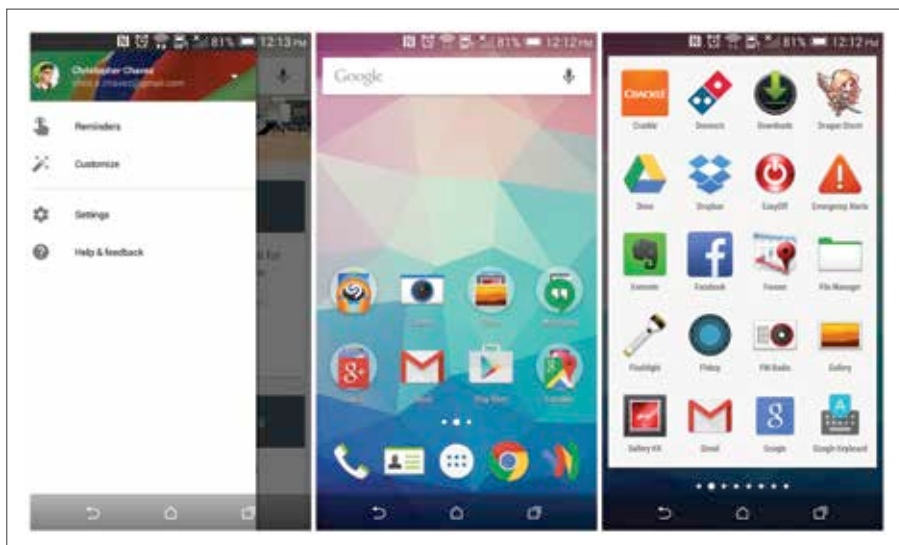
Here's a first look at Orgrim, the enthralling star from the upcoming WoW film: <http://dgit.in/1HdTMiw>

Mars just got printed

SpaceX, owned by tycoon Elon Musk has created some breathtaking posters about life on Mars: <http://dgit.in/1B7GtOl>



Different manufacturers use different user-interfaces for their menus.



The Google Now launcher unifies Android's UI across multiple forks of the OS

has to work with manufacturers to weed out the above mentioned issues.

Update delays

A direct repercussion of the above problem is that a majority of Android users are never on the latest Android update. This is because even though Google makes the updates available to everyone, the manufacturers have to make the update conform to their respective custom UIs or forks.

Depending on the company, and the handset, the delay may be for a week, a month or, never at all. As a result, Android users miss out on a lot of benefits and critical bug fixes for the system.

To get an idea of how serious this issue is, take a look at the pie chart from the Android developers dashboard which shows that by the first week of April, only 5.4% of Android phones were on Lollipop, an update that was released in the first half of November last year. The chart also shows that nearly 20% of Android phones are still on a version of Jelly Bean that was released in October of 2012.

In comparison, about 73.2% of iOS users are currently using iOS 8 or later, less than seven months after the update was made available. Of course, it's worth noting here that iOS had just under 15% of the market share in 2014, as opposed to Android's 81.5%, so the problem is bound to be magnified in the latter's case.

The Solution: As with the previous point, Google is tackling this issue, primarily by bringing all of its core apps, under the purview of the Play Store. This ensures that the core apps at least are updated regardless of fragmentation.

None of the above is enough to deal with this issue. Google needs to take the risk of angering its partners and take a harder stand on updates because ultimately, it's the user who will suffer.

Security

Security has always been a kind of bogeyman for Android because the threat is blown completely out of proportion. As we saw with Windows, Android's presence is so large that it's bound to be a big target for all manner of virus, malware